

Employee Assistance Program Guide

What the EAP Covers

The Contoso Employee Assistance Program (EAP) provides up to 6 free confidential counseling sessions per issue, per year, for employees and their household members. Sessions can be used for a range of concerns including stress, grief, relationship issues, and substance use, and a new 6-session allotment is available for each distinct issue, not a single shared pool across all concerns.

Additional Services

The EAP also offers free legal consultations (up to 1 hour per matter), financial planning sessions, and childcare/eldercare referral services, all administered by the same third-party provider as the counseling benefit, so a single phone call can connect an employee to whichever of these services fits their situation.

How to Access

Call the EAP support line at 1-800-555-0199, available 24/7, or visit the EAP portal linked from the Contoso benefits page. All contact is confidential and not shared with Contoso Corp, including whether a given employee has used the service at all — Contoso Corp only ever sees aggregate, anonymized utilization statistics, never individual usage records.

Crisis Support

For an immediate mental health crisis, the EAP line offers a dedicated crisis option available at the same number, staffed by licensed clinicians who can also connect the caller to local emergency services if needed. This crisis option does not count against the standard 6-session annual allotment described above.

Managers who become aware an employee may be in crisis are encouraged, but not required, to share the EAP crisis number directly; managers are never expected to assess or manage a mental health crisis themselves, and doing so is explicitly discouraged in favor of connecting the employee to the trained clinicians on the EAP line.

Manager Referrals

A manager who is concerned about an employee's wellbeing based on observable workplace performance (not a diagnosis, which managers are not qualified to make) may suggest the employee consider the EAP; this suggestion must never be framed as a condition of continued employment, and

using it that way is itself a policy violation.

Household Member Eligibility

Household members eligible for EAP services include a spouse or domestic partner and any dependent living in the employee's home, including college-age dependents living away for school; the household member does not need to be enrolled in Contoso Corp's health insurance to be eligible for the EAP, since the two benefits are administered separately.